PAIGNTON CRICKET CLUB

CAPTAINCY & SELECTION POLICY

Effective: 2026 Season and Ongoing

This policy applies to all senior teams, including the Women's XI, unless superseded by a specific team policy.

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SECTION A — CLUBWIDE POLICY

These policies apply universally to **all Paignton Cricket Club Senior XIs** and exist to ensure consistency, high standards, fairness, and development across the entire senior playing structure.

1. Purpose of the Policy

This policy sets the standards for:

- Consistent and fair team selection across all XIs
- Maintaining competitive teams at every level
- Supporting progression and development for players of all ages
- Ensuring high standards, respect, and positive behaviour throughout the club
- Providing clear expectations for training, availability, conduct, and communication
- Creating an aligned club culture where every player understands their role and responsibilities

This policy consolidates the core expectations shared among all XIs while allowing for unique requirements in specific teams.

2. Club Identity & Player Pathway

Paignton Cricket Club operates a structured, transparent pathway intended to:

- Develop players safely from junior to senior cricket
- Transition players upward through teams based on readiness, performance, and attitude
- Provide opportunities at all levels for participation, development, and enjoyment
- Promote competitiveness without compromising individual player welfare
- Maintain strong links between captains, junior coaches, and the selection committee

Each XI contributes differently to the club's wider goals:

- **1st XI** — Compete at the highest standard and represent the club with exemplary professionalism
- **2nd XI** — Compete strongly while preparing players for potential 1st XI cricket
- **3rd XI** — Offer competitive cricket that bridges junior/development cricket and higher senior levels
- **4th XI** — Provide opportunity, safe junior transition, and development while supporting senior player involvement

This pathway supports both **performance-focused progression** and **participation-focused opportunity**, depending on each player's needs.

3. Club wide Selection Principles

Selection must aim to be as fair and transparent as possible and be aligned with the club's values.

3.1 Strongest Available Team

Unless there are exceptional circumstances agreed with the captain, players are expected to play for the team they are selected for.

Each XI will select the strongest available side based on:

- Player form and recent performances
- Attitude, behaviour, and professionalism
- Training attendance and effort
- Team balance and specific role requirements
- Commitment to the club and teammates

3.2 Movement Between Teams

Movement upward or downward between teams is a fundamental part of player development and competitive sport in general.

- Players performing well will be considered for promotion.
- Players needing more time or form may temporarily move to lower XIs.
- Changes will be communicated respectfully and directly before teams are publicly announced.

3.3 Role Clarity

Where practicable, players selected will be provided with an outline of their likely role within the team. This may include:

- Their batting position
- Expected overs or bowling role
- Fielding role and team responsibilities
- Leadership or mentoring expectations (where applicable)

Roles may change during a match in response to conditions, tactics, or team needs, and final decisions rest with the captain.

3.4 League Regulations (Loan Players & Artificial Strengthening)

Paignton Cricket Club operates within the regulations set by the Devon Cricket League regarding player eligibility, loan players, and artificial strengthening.

Where circumstances require players to represent teams outside of their normal side (including temporary loans or movement between teams), these decisions must comply with Devon Cricket League rules.

As these regulations may change from time to time, the club will always defer to the official Devon Cricket League documentation.

Current regulations can be found at: https://devoncl.play-cricket.com/docs

Captains and selectors are responsible for ensuring all selections comply with these league regulations.

4. Conduct, Behaviour & Team Culture

All players represent Paignton Cricket Club and are expected to uphold high standards. Players are encouraged to support the club by socialising after matches and attending club social events where possible, helping to build a strong, inclusive club culture.

4.1 Behaviour Expectations

Players must:

- Demonstrate respect toward umpires, opposition, teammates, and captains
- Uphold the Spirit of Cricket
- Maintain positive body language and energy
- Avoid dissent, abuse, or negative behaviour
- Support teammates on and off the field
- Serve as role models, particularly when playing alongside juniors

4.2 Standards

Players are expected to:

- Arrive on time for matches and team talks
- Prepare thoroughly
- Uphold high personal and team standards
- Behave respectfully at all times, on and off the field
- Ensure match fees and/or membership fees are paid

4.2 Match fees and membership

All players are expected to pay membership subscriptions by the end of May and match fees (including teas where applicable) prior to the start of each match.

Failure to meet financial commitments without prior agreement may impact selection for subsequent matches.

5. Training & Commitment Requirements

Training is essential for maintaining competitive standards and player development. Player's training expectations at Paignton may vary by team level, but training attendance and attitude will be considered in selection across all XIs.

5.1 Attendance

Players selected for any XI are expected to:

- Attend training regularly
- Notify their captain promptly if they cannot attend
- Contribute positively to training sessions
- Of paid membership/fees, or have sponsorship where possible

5.2 Attitude & Effort

Players should:

- Display strong effort and focus
- Work on areas identified by captains/coaches
- Support the team environment and help others improve

Training attitude may directly influence selection decisions.

6. Availability & Communication Standards

6.1 Recording Availability

Players must record availability for matches and training through the club's designated system (currently Spond).

Availability must remain accurate and up to date at all times.

6.2 Update Timeliness

Players should:

- Confirm availability as early as possible
- Avoid last-minute changes except for unavoidable reasons

6.3 Late Withdrawals

Late withdrawals should only occur due to:

- Illness
- Injury
- Genuine emergency

Players must notify their captain directly as well as update the system.

Repeated late withdrawals may impact future selection.

6.4 Communication of Selection Decisions

Captains will communicate:

- Promotions
- Demotions
- Non-selection

...respectfully and directly, before any public posting of teams where possible.

6.5 Team Announcements

Captains should publish selected teams in a timely manner each week.

The 1st XI specifically aims to announce its team by **Wednesday evening,** giving the rest of the squads chance to adapt and announce by **Thursday evening.**

7. Junior Development & Safety

Paignton Cricket Club is committed to safely developing junior players through senior cricket. PCC operates in line with ECB Safeguarding policies and Clubmark accreditation standards.

7.1 Safe Selection

Junior players will only be selected when:

- It is safe for them to play adult cricket
- It supports their development
- Appropriate senior support is available
- Membership is paid.

Captains may consult junior coaches and selection leads when necessary.

7.2 Support & Mentoring

Juniors selected for senior cricket will receive:

- Clear roles
- Guidance and mentoring from senior players
- Appropriate fielding positions and responsibilities
- Encouragement and constructive feedback

7.3 Fair Development Opportunities

Juniors may be part of structured rotation systems to manage opportunity and development across squads.

7.4 Junior Selection Philosophy

Junior selection aims vary by age group and team, balancing enjoyment, development, and appropriate competitiveness. Selection decisions will prioritise player welfare, long-term development, and positive cricketing experiences over short-term results.

8. Governance & Selection Authority

8.1 Role of Captains and Selectors

Overall selection governance sits with the Selection Committee, chaired by the Chair of Selectors, with captains responsible for weekly team selection in line with this policy.

8.2 Confidentiality

Selection discussions are confidential within the selection group.

8.3 Feedback

Players may request feedback at any time, and captains will offer guidance respectfully.

8.4 Player concerns and complaints process

Players (or parents/guardians of junior players) with concerns should follow the club's communication pathway:

- Team Captain
- Chair of Selectors
- PCC Committee

Concerns should be raised respectfully and privately. Public criticism or discussion on social media is not acceptable.

SECTION B — TEAM-SPECIFIC POLICIES

These rules apply **in addition to** the clubwide policies.

9. 1st XI Policy — Additional Requirements

The 1st XI is the club's flagship side, competing at the highest level available.

9.1 Selection Philosophy

- The 1st XI will field the strongest team possible to maximise winning potential.
- Performance, attitude, and commitment are central to selection decisions.

9.2 Training Expectations

Players must:

- Attend all training sessions unless prior notice is provided
- Arrive on time and stay for the entirety
- Demonstrate Premier Division-level standards in preparation and intensity

9.3 Matchday Standards

Players must:

- Arrive **at least 60 minutes before** the scheduled start (unless previously agreed)
- Maintain energy, body language, and focus throughout the match
- Uphold the Paignton CC standards

9.4 Availability

The 1st XI requires all availability to be managed through Spond.

9.5 Communication

Promotions/demotions will always be communicated personally.

9.6 Review & Acknowledgement

The 1st XI policy will be reviewed mid-season.

All 1st XI squad members confirm their agreement by signing the policy.

10. 2nd XI Policy — Additional Requirements

The 2nd XI has a dual mandate: compete strongly and prepare players for 1st XI cricket.

10.1 Team Identity

- Maintain competitive standards
- Reflect 1st XI behaviours and expectations
- Provide stepping-stone opportunities for progressing players

10.2 Selection

Selection considers:

- Competitiveness
- Player development
- Attitude and training commitment
- Team consistency and balance

10.3 Junior Development

Juniors are introduced when beneficial, with clear roles and senior support.

10.4 Player Expectations

Players must:

- Attend training regularly
- Conform to Paignton CC standards
- Uphold club values

11. 3rd XI Policy — Additional Requirements

The 3rd XI bridges the development gap between junior/4th XI cricket and higher senior cricket.

11.1 Purpose

- Provide competitive senior cricket
- Support developing players
- Offer a platform for players pushing for 2nd XI selection

11.2 Cup Competitions

Cup matches will be selected using the **strongest eligible players across all club teams**, consistent with club strategy.

11.3 Expectations

Players must:

- Communicate availability promptly
- Attend training when possible
- Display excellent body language and positivity
- Show high energy and work rate
- Support juniors and developing players

11.4 Leadership Commitment

The captain will:

- Lead by example
- Communicate clearly
- Support player development
- Provide constructive feedback

12. 4th XI Policy — Additional Requirements

The 4th XI provides opportunity, encourages participation, and supports junior transition.

12.1 Aims

- Fast-track talented youngsters
- Provide cricket for adults and developing players
- Offer safe and structured exposure to adult cricket for juniors
- Play competitive cricket to the best of the team's ability

12.2 Selection Criteria

Selection considers:

- Safety and readiness
- Training attendance
- Consistent availability
- Positive attitude and behaviour
- Completed membership/sponsorship (required)

12.3 Junior Grouping System

Juniors may be placed into one of three groups:

1. **Rotate** – May rotate to other appropriate club sides
2. **Three-Game Rotation** – Play regularly via structured rotation
3. **Play as Much as Possible** – High-priority developing juniors

12.4 Authority

Selections are made jointly by:

- The 4th XI Captain
- The Head of 3rd/4th XI Selection

12.5 Conduct

Negative behaviour will not be tolerated and may be referred to the Selection Committee.

POLICY SIGN-OFF & ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

By signing this document, the undersigned confirm they have read, understood, and agree to uphold the **Paignton Cricket Club Captaincy & Selection Policy**.

Captains

1st XI Captain: _____ **Date:** _____

2nd XI Captain: _____ **Date:** _____

3rd XI Captain: _____ **Date:** _____

4th XI Captain: _____ **Date:** _____

Additional Required Signatures

Selection Committee Chair: _____ **Date:** _____

Club Chairperson: _____ **Date:** _____